Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report

Licensee: Northwest Youth Discovery (NWYD)
Executive Director: Richard Streeter
Board Chair: Jennifer Weeks
Date of Unannounced: August 29, 2024
Licensing Coordinator: Todd Cooley
Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: OYA

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings	Repeat Findings Further Action Needed	Comments
Personnel Files 419-400-0120 • (1)(a) & (3)(c) Background check completed and documented New background checks were not conducted upon promotion or position changes. **Corrective action:** Create process to ensure new background checks are performed when staff change position or promote within the organization. - There had been no new internal promotions or position changes at the 12/2023 Unannounced Visit.	**Yes☐ No✓**	There had still not been any internal promotions or position changes. The program is aware of this requirement and there will be no further action required.
Ongoing Training 419-470-0120 (2)(a) Environmental emergencies	**Yes✓ No☐**	The updated recertification training checklist has all required ongoing training except for environmental emergencies.

419-470-0120 (2)(b) Universal Precautions 419-470-0120 (2)(c) Discipline and Behavior Management 419-470-0120 (4) Designated staff authorized to apply reasonable and prudent parent standard are trained in application of the standard 419-400-0120(5) Mandatory reporting The ongoing training required by licensing was not being properly documented in employee files. **Corrective action:** Create system to ensure all required ongoing training is provided to staff and documented in their files consistently.		**Corrective action:** Environmental emergencies needs to be added to the training checklist to ensure this ongoing training is properly documented for all employees.
Health Services 419-470-0090 (2)(e) Documentation of age-appropriate instruction – pregnancy prevention, nutrition, prevention of HIV & AIDS, and prevention and treatment of sexually transmitted disease • This education is being done at intake and on multiple other occasions during clients stay. It is not currently being documented in a manner that can be easily sorted from other day-to-day notes. Program has already identified a way to correct this by formalizing a process with the primary care provider with whom they have established a fantastic working relationship.	**Yes☐ No✓**	Documentation can be found in the client file in hard copy or is accessible on MyChart as well. No further action required.

Records Relating to Restraint & Involuntary Seclusion 419-400-0180(13)(e) Each child caring agency shall provide notice regarding how to access the quarterly reports to the parents or guardians of children in care in the program. The child caring agency shall provide the notice upon the child in care's admission and at least two times each year thereafter. 419-400-0190(1) Information provided to children in care relating to Restraint & Involuntary Seclusion • The program is currently not providing this information in formal documentation, although all of their client's guardians are OYA JPPO's and are familiar on where to find the information. Discussed adding language to the intake packet and service plans in order to meet this requirement.	**Yes☐ No✓**	This notice is now part of the MSP review process in which the JPPO's sign off on at least quarterly. No further action is required.

New Findings from Site Visit	Comments
419-400-0120 **Licensing Umbrella Rules: Personnel** (4) Staff orientation. A child-caring agency must provide training to each newly hired employee within 30 days of employment on all of the following subjects:	The new team member training checklist did not clearly address training for attributes of the population served. Privacy rules was also being covered with HIPAA training. The privacy training needs to include privacy outside of health-related information as well. Staff should receive training on not providing names, images, etc. to outside entities, in correspondence, or on social media without prior consent. **Corrective action:** Add training topics to new team member training checklist and augment privacy training curriculum to include aspects of privacy beyond what is specific to HIPPA.

(a) Child-caring agency policies and procedures. (b) Ethical and professional guidelines. (c) Suicide prevention and intervention. **(d) Attributes of population served.** (e) Child-abuse reporting laws and requirements including the definitions of abuse that apply specifically to a child in care. **(f) Privacy laws.** (g) Emergency procedures.	

Interview Summary
During the unannounced visit licensing spoke with one staff and two clients. Staff was a local student at the Oregon State University Cascades campus and said it was great experience to be able to work with youth. One of their professors at the school actually recommended seeking employment with Northwest Youth Discovery. They enjoyed the work and the flexibility of the program as they were getting ready to go back to school. This was the first residential program they had worked at, and they had no concerns or issues. Staff felt there was plenty of training provided, and they were comfortable working there. The two clients opted to be interviewed together. Both clients had been at the program for several months and had also been at multiple prior placements. Clients provided the following information: - - They feel safe and comfortable in the program with multiple staff they can talk to if there are issues. - The food is good. They get to help with food prep and have input on the menu with a Chef's Choice once a week where they can choose a favorite dish. - Groups are good most of the time. Some of the facilitators are just okay and seem to be going through the motions. No specifics were provided. - They get to do a lot of activities. Some of the recent activities included golf lessons, kayaking, tie dying, roller skating, trampoline park, hikes and much more. - Clients said they receive 3-5 calls a week that are limited to 10 minutes. They said staff are pretty strict with the 10 min limit and they don't always get to finish up properly if they are discussing something emotional or sensitive due to the limits. - They like they are able to attend public school, which is something not offered at any of the other programs they had attended. - Enjoy having access to hygiene (makeup, perfume, etc.) without having to earn "levels" like at other programs. - Clients felt the petition process could be more efficient. Currently if they would like to request things like personal walks, lashes/nails, etc. they have to complete a form and get every full-time staff to sign it. They felt it would be better if they only had to get each supervisor to sign off. - They did not like the restriction on tv and movies to only G and PG rated programming because they were all over 13. Clients did say this was also something they could petition for if there was a movie PG-13 or higher they wanted to watch. Clients were very positive on Northwest Youth Discovery and their time there. One of the clients has a plan to return home in just another month or two while the other is looking at options to do a variation of independent living while remaining at the home.

Observations
Program was at capacity with 10 clients. The home was clean and in good repair. Staff was preparing lunch during visit and the cupboards and refrigerator both had sufficient food. Discussed updating training checklists to ensure compliance licensing requirements for new employees and ongoing training. This would include adding to new employee training checklist attributes of population served and expanding the privacy laws from just HIPAA to include privacy of other personal information. Also add environmental emergencies to the ongoing training checklist.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes:
Please submit the following to verify compliance.
Within 45 days of receipt of this report **Northwest Youth Discovery** must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents can be emailed directly to **Todd Cooley** **todd.cooley@odhsoha.oregon.gov.**

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: Todd Cooley Date: 09-20-2024

Manager Review: _____ Date: 09-18-2024